Mark Cheli

Director, Product Operations & Strategy · Onshape (PTC)

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I'm the director of Onshape's Product Operations & Strategy team at PTC. The team handles the planning and review cycle for the product org, product analytics, the rollout of AI tools across R&D, localization, and a few internal tools. I came up through engineering and still write code when it's the fastest way to get something done. Outside work I run a homelab and build small apps on it.

EXPERIENCE

Director, Product Operations & Strategy
Jan 2022 – present

PTC — Onshape · Boston, MA

Director of a small product operations team inside Onshape, PTC's cloud CAD product. The team's job is to keep the product org planned, measured and equipped: the planning cycle, product analytics, AI tooling for engineering, localization, and internal tools.

- Planning: the product org's annual planning and ongoing review cycle.
- Analytics: product analytics and the data warehouse that product and go-to-market teams work from.
- AI adoption: the rollout of AI development tools across R&D, and the guidelines and governance that go with it.
- Localization: localization operations for the product.
- Hands-on: internal tools and integrations, built in-house when that's the fastest route.
- 2022: interim head of business operations for the Onshape business unit.

Director, Education Product
Feb 2021 – Jan 2022

PTC · Boston, MA

Product for PTC's Education group: services, support, partnerships, community and marketing for the academic programs around Onshape, Creo and ThingWorx.

Senior Manager, Education Experience
Jan 2020 – Feb 2021

PTC · Boston, MA

The education customer experience after PTC acquired Onshape.

Senior Manager, Customer Training Technology & Research
Jan 2019 – Jan 2020

PTC · Boston, MA

Product for PTC's customer training: eLearning, virtual instructor-led training and in-product help. A 40-person group across the US and Pune.

Senior Software Development Manager, PTC University EdTech R&D

May 2018 – Jan 2019

PTC · Needham, MA

Engineering management for PTC's learning platforms: 35 engineers in three teams.

Technology Lead, Academic & Customer Training Products

Apr 2017 – May 2018

PTC · Needham, MA

Lead engineer and product manager for IoTU.com and the academic product line, with teams in the US and India.

Senior Full-Stack Software Engineer

Oct 2016 – Apr 2017

PTC · Needham, MA

Led the academic software development group. IoT education products on the MEAN stack and ThingWorx.

Academic Software Engineer

May 2013 – Oct 2016

PTC · Needham, MA

Started as a student intern, then full-time. Curriculum, demos and applications for Creo, Windchill, Mathcad and ThingWorx.

Web Developer

Dec 2012 – Dec 2014

Freelance

Small-business websites: HTML/CSS, PHP/MySQL, WordPress.

Assistant Program Facilitator

Dec 2011 – May 2013

Christa McAuliffe Center / Challenger Learning Center, Framingham State University

Planetarium shows and simulated space missions for middle-school groups, plus the center's IT.

EDUCATION

B.S., Business & Information Technology

2011 – 2015

Framingham State University · Summa Cum Laude, GPA 3.94

CERTIFICATES

- Certified Onshape Associate · Onshape · 2021-01

SKILLS

Product operations	Planning cycles · Product analytics · Localization operations · AI tooling adoption · Hiring and management
Data	SQL · AWS Redshift · dbt · Prefect · Streamlit · Looker

Building	Python (Flask, FastAPI) · TypeScript (Vue, Nuxt) · PostgreSQL · Docker · GitHub Actions · Linux
AI tooling	Claude Code · GitHub Copilot · MCP servers · Agentic coding setups

INTERESTS

Homelab & self-hosting	Dell PowerEdge R630 · Docker · Observability
Sim racing & flight sim	iRacing · DCS · RigReady
Old trucks	1991 Honda Acty · 1997 GMC Suburban · 1996 Mazda B4000
Outdoors	Backpacking · Car camping · Ham radio
Making	3D printing · Welding · Woodworking

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